

Concept Note

Diaspora Support and Representation Services

Sozo Consulting PLC

February 2026

Introduction

Over the past two decades, the Ethiopian diaspora has grown into one of the country's most important economic and social partners.

Millions of Ethiopians living abroad continue to support their families, invest in property, establish businesses, fund community projects, and contribute to national development.

Despite this strong connection, many members of the diaspora face serious challenges when trying to manage their affairs in Ethiopia from a distance.

Procedures are often unclear, institutions are difficult to navigate remotely, and trusted professional representation is limited.

This concept note presents Sozo Consulting PLC's proposal to establish a structured Diaspora Support and Representation Service that responds directly to these realities.

Background and Rationale

Most diaspora members depend on relatives, informal agents, or unverified brokers to handle legal, financial, and administrative matters.

While this approach may appear convenient, it frequently results in miscommunication, delays, financial losses, and legal disputes.

Many diaspora clients express frustration about repeated document rejections, unresolved property issues, stalled business registrations, and unclear banking procedures. These challenges discourage further investment and weaken long-term engagement.

Sozo Consulting PLC has developed strong institutional relationships, operational experience, and technical capacity.

This positions the company to provide reliable, transparent, and professional services tailored to diaspora needs.

Objectives

The main objectives of this initiative are:

- To provide trusted legal and administrative representation for diaspora clients.
- To simplify cross-border transactions and documentation.
- To protect diaspora investments and assets.
- To promote structured and transparent engagement.
- To generate sustainable income for Sozo Consulting PLC.
- To strengthen institutional confidence between diaspora communities and local institutions.

Proposed Services

The proposed Diaspora Support and Representation Service will operate through a combination of digital systems and on-ground operations.

Key service areas will include:

1. Power of Attorney Management

Preparation, authentication, storage, renewal, and execution of legal mandates.

2. Banking and Financial Facilitation

Support in opening diaspora accounts, remittance compliance, investment transfers, and loan applications.

3. Property and Asset Management

Title verification, transaction support, rental supervision, and maintenance coordination.

4. Business and Investment Support

Company registration, licensing, partner vetting, and regulatory compliance.

5. Import, Donation, and Logistics Support

Customs clearance, documentation review, delivery coordination, and reporting.

6. Family and Personal Support

Education placement, medical coordination, inheritance support, and emergency assistance.

7. Project and Donation Management

Project supervision, monitoring, evaluation, and financial reporting.

Implementation Approach

Implementation will follow a phased approach.

Phase One will focus on establishing legal frameworks, preparing service templates, building digital intake systems, and training staff.

Phase Two will introduce pilot services to selected diaspora communities, refine operational procedures, and establish performance benchmarks.

Phase Three will expand geographic coverage, strengthen institutional partnerships, and introduce advanced digital tools.

Throughout implementation, emphasis will be placed on service quality, responsiveness, and ethical conduct.

Organizational Structure

The program will operate under a dedicated Diaspora Services Unit within Sozo Consulting PLC.

The Unit will include:

- Client Relations Officers
- Legal and Compliance Coordinators
- Banking and Finance Liaison Officers
- Logistics and Operations Managers
- Digital Platform Administrators

This structure ensures professional accountability and operational efficiency.

Financial Sustainability

The initiative will be financed through service fees, annual subscriptions, transaction commissions, and project management charges.

A diversified revenue model will reduce dependency on any single income source and support long-term sustainability.

Financial projections indicate that moderate market penetration will allow the program to reach operational break-even within two to three years.

Risk Management

Key risks include regulatory changes, data security threats, partner underperformance, and reputational exposure.

These risks will be managed through strong compliance systems, contractual safeguards, insurance coverage, regular audits, and continuous staff training.

Expected Outcomes

The proposed service is expected to deliver the following outcomes:

- Improved access to professional services for diaspora clients.
- Reduced transaction delays and disputes.
- Increased volume of formal investments.
- Enhanced transparency and accountability.
- Strengthened institutional reputation of Sozo Consulting PLC.
- Creation of skilled employment opportunities.

Conclusion

The Diaspora Support and Representation Service represents a timely and strategic response to long-standing challenges faced by Ethiopians living abroad.

By combining professional integrity, digital innovation, and local expertise, Sozo Consulting PLC can establish itself as the preferred partner for diaspora engagement.

This initiative aligns commercial sustainability with national development objectives and long-term institutional growth.